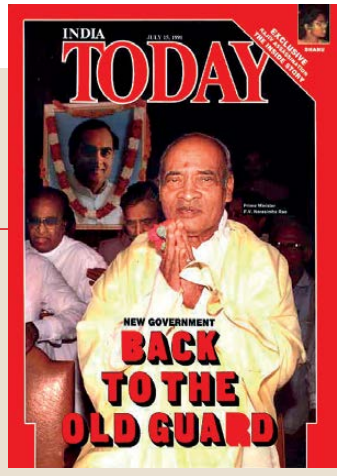




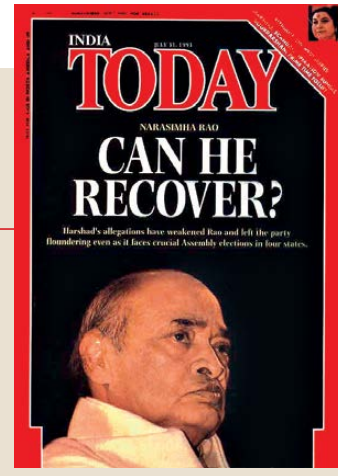
PRASHANT PANJIAR

BEHIND THE SCENES (Top) An INDIA TODAY cartoon by Ravi Shankar on PM Rao's growing clout, 1994; with Chinese Premier Li Peng, 1991



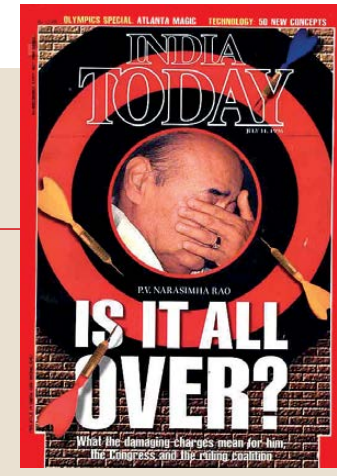
Back to the Old Guard
Jul. 15, 1991

❝ The sobriety, the stifling ennui that characterised the [Congress (I) Parliamentary Party meeting] spoke volumes about the party and the new Government as it assumed the reins of power without the Nehru-Gandhi family at its helm. ❞



Can He Recover?
Jul. 31, 1993

❝ [The PM] will look back ruefully to the monsoon of '93 as the worst of times... Already characterised as indecisive, procrastinative, and a bumbling ditherer, the prime minister, after completing two years in office, must now contend with the additional opprobrium of being labelled a bribe-taker. ❞



Is It All Over?
Jul. 31, 1996

❝ While a strengthened Congress minus Rao may not be happy news for the ruling United Front, senior members of the Deve Gowda Government are...pleased with the party's internal problems. As a senior cabinet minister says, "With the Congress embroiled in its own crises, it will not be able to pull us down even if it wishes to." ❞